

Steve Butterworth

Full-Stack Developer (Ruby on Rails)

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer who turns ideas into working software in days, and keeps it running in production for years. Over 30 Rails applications shipped, used by millions of users across web, mobile and even 30-metre long screens. Contracting since 2013, usually a long-term engagement run alongside shorter product builds.

Purpose pulls me: promoting green issues through my work on EnvironmentJob, and fighting the isolation of remote working through the not-for-profit co-working space I co-founded.

Happiest owning the whole loop: talking to non-technical stakeholders, getting a rough version in front of people for early sign-off, then supporting what ships. Years of hard live-event deadlines left a lasting taste for simple solutions that hold up under pressure.

SKILLS

- **Programming and build:** Ruby on Rails, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo/Stimulus), Tailwind, React, D3.js, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, RSpec, Git/GitHub.
- **Agentic coding:** daily use of Claude Code and Codex, driven by a suite of strict SDLC skills: task breakdown, test-first development, coding standards, and security and performance audits.
- **Prototyping and product development:** working proofs of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off; rough versions in front of users early and often; quick to pick up new tools.
- **Systems integration:** third-party APIs, live data feeds, browser automation and LLM services woven into products; a bias for the least machinery that works.
- **User focus and communication:** direct daily contact with non-technical customers and stakeholders; plain-English explanation of technical trade-offs; comfortable bridging design, product and engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Rails Developer, EnvironmentJob (contract)

2013 - Present

- Work closely with the company directors to build and maintain the UK's leading environmental jobs website, along with their other web properties.
- Sole engineer across search, advertiser and job-seeker tools, admin, CRM and reporting; changes ship in days and stay in production for years.
- Introduced Elasticsearch full-text search with faceted filtering, and an email alert system sending over 150k emails a week.
- Created AI-powered import, clean-up and classification systems, and a tool monitoring new job postings across hundreds of websites.
- Carried the platform through every upgrade from Rails 1 to Rails 8.

Founder & Developer, ChangeFlow

2023 - Present

- Founded an AI-powered website monitoring and alerting SaaS, trusted by Am Law 200 law firms; shipped the first working product in weeks, solo.
- Work directly with customers to shape the product, turning requested features around in hours.
- Engineered LLM pipelines for classification, summarisation and data cleaning, plus an in-app tool-calling AI agent.
- Now a stable, lightly-maintained side product rather than a full-time venture.

Senior Rails Developer, LEX (contract)

2019 - 2023

- Built ShotView, live 3D golf shot tracking in Three.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship, BMW International Open and Indy 500, serving over 1 million visits a day within 4 months.
- Turned creative concepts into working prototypes in days to win sign-off, then grew them into finished products.
- Created the NTT DataWall, a 30-metre live data experience and the centrepiece of The Open's fan village.
- Shipped tablet and mobile apps for live brand activations, and touch-screen conference interactives including live polling and games.
- Led a small engineering team within a wider multidisciplinary team of creative directors, designers and producers.

Senior Rails Developer, GlaxoSmithKline Analytics Platform (contract, via Retechnica)

2019

- Delivered an early proof of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off, then built out medical voice-of-customer analysis, interactive visualisation and PDF/PPT export; shipped on time and on budget, scoring 9/10 satisfaction from 50+ stakeholders.

Senior Rails Developer, Pulse Group (contract)

2013 - 2018

- Developed live event data walls and public event websites in Rails/JavaScript/D3.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship.
- Delivered big live data screens for Team GB at the Olympic Games.
- Built reporting tools and touch-screen interactives for Emirates Airline.

Founder & Lead Developer, Flumes

2010 - 2013

- Founded and built a social media analytics and visualisation platform from zero: live social data collected, enriched via third-party classification APIs and made explorable through interactive visualisation.
- The platform became the technical foundation for later live-event work delivered for the likes of Cambridge University Press and Team GB.

Lead Rails Developer, AlphaSights

2008 - 2010

- First employee: set the technology direction with the founders, recruited and led the initial Rails team, and built the bespoke CRM and client portal underpinning the firm's communications.

EARLIER ROLES

- **Rails & PHP Developer, Humble Technologies** (2006 - 2008): web consultancy for UK clients.
- **Senior Software Engineer, i2 Inc. (now IBM)** (2002 - 2005): led the web version of the flagship analytics tool; built a Java/JS charting SDK.
- **Software Developer, Crystal Decisions (now SAP)** (1999 - 2001): enterprise OLAP components and a front-end JavaScript SDK; mentored new developers.

ADDITIONAL

- **Co-Founder, Unicorn Studios Ipswich** (2019 - Present): co-founded a not-for-profit community co-working space for remote workers, freelancers and contractors.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 1st Class